BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha, Australia
Workplace Health and Safety Policy

Version	Version 1.1
Approved by Board on	10 October 2020
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1. Introduction

1.1 BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Sanstha, Australia Ltd ("BAPS Australia") is committed to safeguarding the health, safety and welfare of all workers and volunteers who interact with BAPS Australia and complying with its occupational health and safety obligations.

2. Purpose

2.1 The purpose of this policy is to provide guidelines to, **as far as reasonably practicable**:

a. prevent workplace injuries and illnesses
b. promote a safe and healthy workplace culture
c. provide a framework for consulting, collaborating and communicating with workers and volunteers and the National and Local workplace health and safety coordinators as well as the relevant administrators of the Mandir
d. consider workplace health and safety in project/activities planning and work
e. allocate adequate resources to prevent health and safety risks and promote a safe and healthy work environment
f. ensure that workers and volunteers understand their rights and responsibilities, and can identify and control risks in the workplace
g. drive continuous improvement in workplace health and safety.

3. Scope

3.1 This policy applies to the following, together referred to as **'workers'**:

Employees	Directors	Officers	Volunteers	Suppliers
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

4. Definitions

4.1 In this policy, **'workplace'** means places where people work and volunteer in connection with BAPS Australia, whether held on-site at its Mandirs or off-site.

4.2 **'Occupational violence'** refers to any incident where a person is physically attacked, abused, assaulted or threatened in the workplace.

5. Commitment to workplace health and safety

5.1 BAPS Australia aims to safeguard the rights of all people and volunteers to work in an environment that is safe and does not pose risks to health.

5.2 BAPS Australia is committed to working in partnership with all workers and volunteers to identify and address workplace health and safety issues. Each Mandir has a dedicated workplace health and safety coordinator (hereto referred to as the **Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator)** who will work with the Mandir Coordinator and the relevant Admin Coordinator to identify and address workplace health and safety issues within their Mandir.

5.3 BAPS Australia is committed to continuously improving its workplace health and safety practices through the ongoing development of systems and processes to:

a. identify, assess and control workplace hazards
b. reduce the incidence and cost of occupational injury and illness

5.4 BAPS Australia is committed to ensuring all workers and volunteers are free from bullying and occupational violence in the workplace.

6. Workplace Health and Safety Committee and representatives

6.1 A Workplace Health and Safety Committee will be made up of:

a. the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator for each Mandir
b. the Local Facilities Coordinator for each Mandir
c. the Company Secretary
d. the Administrative Secretary. The Administrative Secretary will also perform the role of **National Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator.**

6.2 The Workplace Health and Safety Committee will meet at least quarterly. The Administrative Secretary will chair the meeting and send out an agenda before the meeting. A designated note-taker will take minutes of the meeting.

6.3 Committee members are encouraged to work with management to discuss workplace health and safety issues, and to work with management to improve health and safety standards.

7. Responsibilities

7.1 The **Board of Trustees** will:

a. demonstrate a commitment to providing and maintaining a safe and healthy workplace
b. provide all necessary support to the Mandir Coordinators and Mandir Workplace and Safety Health to enable them to maintain a safe and health workplace.

7.2 **The Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator** will:

a. demonstrate a commitment to providing and maintaining a safe and healthy workplace
b. coordinate the identification, development, implementation and review of workplace health and safety policies and procedures within their Mandir
c. work with the Mandir Coordinator and the relevant Admin Coordinator to identify, assess and select measures to control hazards and risks to health and safety within their Mandir
d. work with the Mandir Coordinator and the relevant Admin Coordinator to monitor and evaluate hazard- and risk-control measures
e. work with the Mandir Coordinator and the relevant Admin Coordinator to identify, develop and provide appropriate workplace health and safety-related information, instruction and training to employees and volunteers where necessary

f. monitor and provide regular updates to the Mandir Coordinator and the Workplace Health and Safety Committee on the Mandir's workplace health and safety performance
g. help employees and volunteers to follow policies and safe work procedures.

7.3 The **National Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator** is:
a. responsible for coordinating management of health and safety of employees and volunteers on behalf of the Board of Trustees.
b. use risk identification, assessment and control principles to achieve BAPS Australia's workplace health and safety objectives
c. provide information to the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator on relevant policies, procedures and workplace health and safety obligations

7.4 **The Mandir Coordinator** will:
a. demonstrate a commitment to providing and maintaining a safe and healthy workplace
b. work with the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator to ensure a safe and healthy workplace is provided to all the employees and volunteers at their Mandir
c. work with the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator to ensure that the employees and volunteers avoid placing the themselves or the local community at risk of injury or illness.
d. consult with the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator on a regular basis to review the workplace health and safety procedures and policies of their Mandir and update them as necessary

7.5 **Employees and volunteers** will:
a. demonstrate a commitment to providing and maintaining a safe and healthy workplace
b. participate in workplace health and safety training, actions and activities (if and when organised) and support BAPS Australia in its efforts to achieve its workplace health and safety and, where relevant, rehabilitation objectives
c. follow lawful and reasonable workplace health and safety instructions/procedures from the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator and/or the relevant Admin Coordinator
d. report any serious incidents, accidents, injuries or hazards in the workplace to the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator, their Admin Coordinator or their Mandir Coordinator
e. work in a way that does not endanger the health or safety of themselves or others
f. properly use and maintain safety equipment
g. make sure visitors follow safety rules in the workplace.

7.6 **Visitors to and volunteers** of BAPS Australia will:
a. demonstrate a commitment to providing and maintaining a safe and healthy workplace
b. follow lawful and reasonable workplace health and safety instructions from BAPS Australia
c. report any serious incidents, accidents, injuries or hazards in the workplace to BAPS Australia
d. assess risks to their health and safety arising from the provision of their services
e. have control measures in place to address those risks, including complying with any relevant policies and practices.

7.7 The role of the **Workplace Health and Safety Committee** is to:
a. assist in developing, monitoring and reviewing health and safety policies and procedures

b. consider any proposed or actual changes to the workplace, policies, work practices or procedures which may affect the health and safety of workers
c. promote the importance of health and safety among volunteers

8. Incidents/Breaches

8.1 BAPS Australia takes its health and safety obligations seriously.

8.2 Any breach of this policy or associated workplace health and safety procedures should be immediately raised with Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator and the National Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator should be also be informed.

9. First aid

9.1 A first aid kit is located at the designated location within each Mandir

9.2 The details of the qualified first aid officers at each Mandir can be obtained from the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator and/or the Mandir Coordinator at each Mandir.

10. Reporting

10.1 If an employee/volunteer identifies:
a. a workplace health or safety incident, accident, injury or hazard, including a near miss
b. any non-compliance with BAPS Australia's Workplace Health and Safety Policy or Procedures,
they must report it to their Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator as soon as possible.

10.2 Where a hazard or near miss is identified and/or reported, the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator must submit an **Incident Report and Investigation Form** to their Mandir Coordinator, the National Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator and to the BAPS Australia Company Secretary who will work with the worker, volunteer, Mandir Coordinator and/or the Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator to:
a. identify, assess and select measures to control hazards and risks to health and safety
b. monitor and evaluate hazard- and risk-control measures.

10.3 Incident reports are available from each Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator or the Mandir Coordinator.

10.4 It is imperative that all workers are aware of the procedures to follow in the event that evacuation is required including emergency evacuation procedures. The Local Workplace Health and Safety Coordinator should document the procedures for their relevant centres.

11. Application to the workplace

11.1 This policy applies to any location where duties are performed (i.e. any workplace), as outlined earlier at 4.1.

12. Review

12.1 BAPS Australia's Workplace Health and Safety Policy and Procedures will be reviewed at least every two years. The review will involve assessing the effectiveness of the policy and procedures by (among other things):

a. reviewing overall health and safety performance
b. ensuring continued compliance with the relevant legislation.

13. Related documents

- Incident Report and Investigation Form (Attached)

14. Legislation and industrial instruments

Workplace health and safety laws do not operate in isolation, and other laws also regulate the conduct of employees and other stakeholders in the workplace. All officers, employees, suppliers and volunteers must observe and comply with all laws (Federal or State and Territory based) that relate to their engagement.

Attachment: Incident Reporting Form

BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha, Australia

Incident Report and Investigation Form

Centre Name

Incident Type ☐ Injury/Illness ☐ Property Damage ☐ Near Miss

Reference:

Personal Details of Injured Person

Surname: First Name:

Employee ☐ Contractor ☐ Visitor ☐ Volunteer
(please mark one)

Home Address

Date of Birth

Sex ☐ Male ☐ Female

Contact Details and Contact Number:

Incident Details

Place of Incident

Date of Incident Time of Incident

Description of Incident

Description of injury/illness, property damage, near miss (nature/extent of injuries – include body parts):

Name of reporting person:

Signature of reporting person:

Date Time

Name and contact details of any witnesses